



PHASE 1 FINAL DELIVERABLE

Product and R&D Operating Model

Validate, improve, and activate

October 2026



Agenda



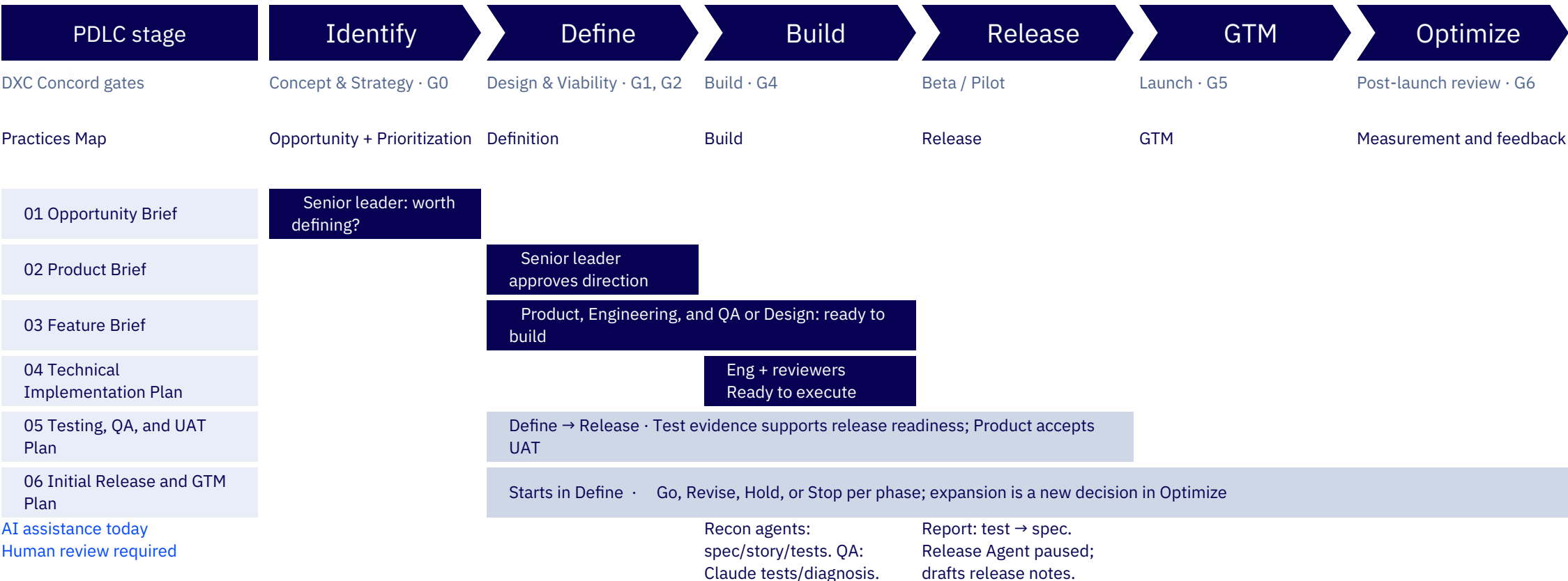
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03 **Recommended Next Phase** 37

Artifacts link stages to review decisions

Testing and release plans start in Define. Each bar names a review decision. Navy bars form the sequential chain; gray bars run in parallel.



Reviews end in Approve, Revise, Hold or Stop. Link Jira, design and tests. Unknowns retain an owner/date. Product + Engineering agree before customer, scope or date commitments.

DELIVERABLE 03

Operating model activation roadmap

Now, Next and Future: prioritized recommendations for practices, decision rights, roles, measures and feedback loops that support scale.

Practices Map

Activation Summary

Recommendations

Executive Summary

Executive Summary

Deliverables

Recommended Next Phase

Coordinate Product and Engineering to realize the SaaS ambition

What we saw

Decision path is inconsistent: opportunity brief → PRD → epic → technical design → implementation plan.

Maturity is uneven: Recon leads design and automation; Core uses manual regression and had 15 unplanned changes in 2026.

Evidence arrives late: delivery lacks end-to-end measures; release validation and post-launch learning are inconsistent.

NOW · 4–6 weeks

Four-week strategy spike: outcomes and six-month roadmaps for every product. In parallel, improve quality, testing and release readiness; introduce lifecycle skills and templates.

NEXT · 1–3 months

Execute roadmaps and adjust priorities with customer and business evidence. Improve lifecycle efficiency and handoffs; develop the business strategy in parallel; roll updated engineering practices into Core.

FUTURE · January

Refresh outcomes and product roadmaps against the new business strategy in January. Execute through the upgraded lifecycle and use outcome measures to guide subsequent decisions.

LEADERSHIP: Name one accountable owner per activation; approve pilot pods; agree delivery principles and ownership; provide Jira, release, test-data and usage access. Use early evidence to extend what works or iterate.

A dozen-plus discovery sessions informed the work

Avinash Manjunath

Engineering

Allys Fritz

UAT

Archana Sabapathy

Product

Paul Smith

Engineering

Amal Endal

Engineering

Mehdi Razavi

UAT

Troy Andrews

Product

Navin Narayanan

Product

Derrick Boyd

Quality

Ashok Kalyani

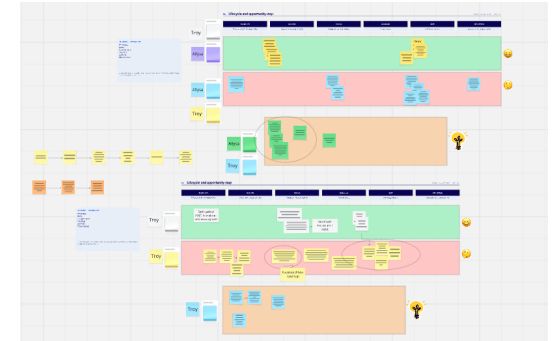
Release

Sapna Sathyanarayana

Product

Bob Franceschini

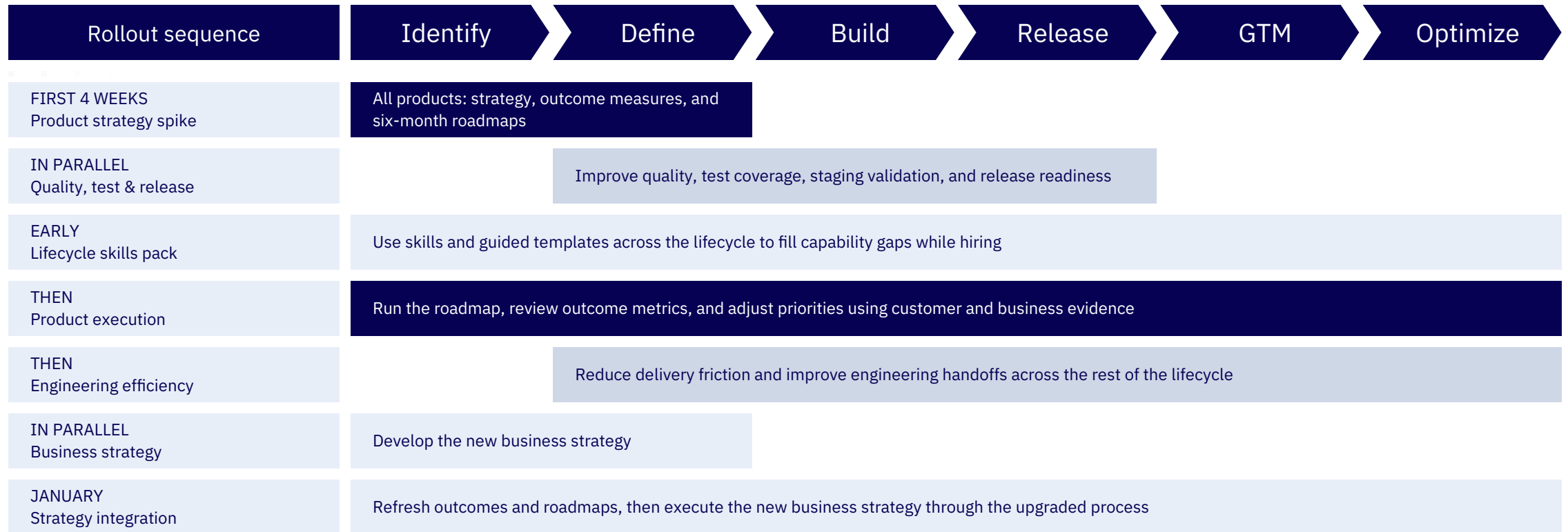
Engineering



In addition to the focused sessions, WM also conducted a collaborative session with the core project group

Focused sessions covered Engineering, Quality/UAT, Release and Product; a collaborative session included the core project group.

Rollout sequence across the PDLC



Product · navy Engineering · gray Both / other · pale blue | Bars show phase coverage, not elapsed time. Outcome priorities now; new business strategy feeds the process in January.

Deliverables

Executive Summary

Deliverables

Recommended Next Phase

Three deliverables, one working structure

01 Validated Product and R&D Practices Map

A maturity-based view of observed strengths, gaps, and opportunities.

02 Activation Summary

A record of bounded changes tested in live work, early signals, and the activation playbook.

03 Prioritized Operating Model Recommendations and Activation Roadmap

Recommended practices, decision rights, roles, measures, feedback loops, owners, and dependencies.

Working inputs already surfaced: internal signals, opportunity briefs, PRDs, feature briefs, epics, implementation plans, agentic delivery patterns, and early interview themes.

Practices Map · working ratings

Practice area	Identify	Define	Build	Release	GTM	Optimize
Customer evidence	Emerging	-	-	-	-	-
Roadmap and prioritization	Developing	-	-	-	-	-
Ownership and decisions	-	Developing	-	-	-	Emerging
Product definition and design	-	Developing	Developing	-	-	Emerging
Product and Engineering delivery	-	-	Variable / pocket	-	-	-
Release validation	-	-	-	Emerging	-	-
Commercialization and enablement	-	-	-	Developing	Developing	Emerging
Measurement and feedback	-	-	-	-	Developing	-
AI-enabled delivery	Emerging	Developing	Leading pocket	Developing	-	-

Ratings are working hypotheses based on limited conversations and observations with DXC team.

Engineering practices by platform

PRACTICE	CORE JAVA	RECONCILE AI	OTHER PODS	EVIDENCE
Technical design	Emerging	Leading pocket	To validate	No design owner before build; Core knowledge concentrated. Recon spec: Team Lead signs.
AI-assisted build	Developing	Leading pocket	Variable	Core Copilot since Jan 2026, human gates; Recon epic agents; others mainly unit tests.
Test automation	Emerging	Leading pocket	Variable	Core manual, one QA. Recon: Jest / Playwright / Postman. XConnect ~100%; others partial.
Release promotion	Developing	Developing	To validate	Release-night merges suggest rebuild vs promotion (confirm); some products outside CAB.
Access / test data	Emerging	Emerging	Emerging	Survey: access/data delays, no read-only DB diagnostics. Recon data wait: months.
Operability / run	Developing	To validate	To validate	Half 2026 Core changes outside cadence; ≥5/11 patches: expired credentials/certificates.
Delivery measures	Emerging	Emerging	Emerging	Core ~65 points/sprint. Recon flow measures proposed, not live. No DORA measures.
Knowledge sharing	Emerging	Emerging	Emerging	Senior-person dependency; thin onboarding. New onshore leads being added.

Working hypotheses to validate with Engineering. Sources: working sessions; engineering survey n=44; 2024–2026 release calendar.

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From signal to implementation plan

A working definition path to test in one selected live initiative, now with an Engineering-owned design step before the plan.



Test intent: make decision logic, feasibility, design context, and evidence visible before the team commits to delivery scope.

Three bounded operating model tests

01 Opportunity signal funnel

CHANGE

Run one internal signal through an opportunity brief with an outcome and decision criterion.

EVIDENCE

Signal quality, decision speed, and next-step clarity.

PLAYBOOK

Weekly review with Product, Engineering, and the initiative owner.

02 Product definition path

CHANGE

Carry one opportunity brief through product brief / PRD, feature brief, epic, technical design and implementation plan.

EVIDENCE

Handoff quality, rework, design context, and decision clarity.

PLAYBOOK

Joint Product and Engineering review before commitment.

03 Ship with proof

CHANGE

Define the smallest release evidence path before the next release or client-facing test.

EVIDENCE

Validation coverage, issues found earlier, and owner clarity.

PLAYBOOK

Evidence review before release, followed by post-launch learning.

Complete the activation record after each test: change made, result or early signal, open question, and recommendation for continued use.

Selected initiatives: engineering baseline

BASELINE	RECONCILE AI: ERA / EFT ENROLLMENT AND KYC	CUSTOM CLAIM SUBMISSION RULES ENGINE
Stage today	Build; MVP target November 2026.	Discovery done; commercialization kickoff next; rough year-end MVP estimate.
Artifacts	PRD, Figma, Architecture Spec, technical stories, UAT design, active Jira.	PRD and Portfolio Governance Board deck; no Jira epic yet.
Platform / team	Node.js / Angular / NX on AWS; lead, ~4 developers, 1 DevSecOps/QA.	Undecided: own team/Jira or Core; partner/client lane (Aspen / TeamTAG).
Delivery	Epic agent pipeline; Kanban/flow proposed; two-week promotion cadence.	Unresolved: Core Scrum/points vs new-platform epic Kanban.
Open question	Review scaling: epic PRs of 100–145 files; DevSecOps WIP limit 2.	Platform, displaced Core capacity and Engineering-informed year-end estimate.
Activation tests	Ship with proof; governed agentic delivery.	Signal funnel; definition path; outcome-led prioritization.
Recon AI tests release evidence and agentic scale; the Rules Engine tests an Engineering-informed commitment before a date is set.		

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Activation Roadmap: product track

RECOMMENDATION / PILOT / OWNER	NOW	NEXT	FUTURE
01 Prioritize outcomes Rules Engine · P+E	Year-end commitment: criteria plus Engineering-informed effort and risk.	Protect support, patch and escalation capacity; show a credible 3–4 sprint view.	Outcome, capacity and predictability evidence guides every pod's portfolio decisions.
02 PM business ownership Reconcile AI · P	Map decision rights; name one PM outcome and learning-loop owner.	After November MVP: review adoption, customer evidence and business results.	PM owns outcomes and learning beyond the backlog on every pod.
03 Definition path Rules Engine · P+E	Run Opportunity, Product and Feature Briefs through the Technical Plan.	Use the templates and review decisions on the next new initiatives.	One definition path across pods, aligned to Concord gates.
04 Earlier collaboration Rules Engine · P+E	Set a pre-commitment session date and minimum cross-functional team.	Include UX, QA, Release and Operations; keep one record of open questions.	Every pod reviews before commitment, tracking wait time and rework.
05 Ship with proof Reconcile AI · P+R+O	Name the highest-risk client workflow before the November MVP.	Define the smallest release evidence path; compare issues before and after.	Post-launch results and adoption feed each pod's next roadmap decision.

Pilot → measure → extend. Owners: P Product; E Engineering; R Release/Ops; O Operations; Q Quality; D DevOps/Infrastructure; S Security.

PRD → signed tech spec → release evidence

01 PRD

The existing PRD, with no epic yet. Product confirms scope and the success measure.

02 Tech spec

The Architecture Design Agent drafts the spec and technical stories; the Team Lead reviews and signs.

03 Release evidence

Product defines what the Release Agent produces: release notes, PRD reconciliation, and destinations.

WHAT WE LEARN

Whether the agent's template works outside Reconcile AI.
How long PRD to signed spec takes with a human gate.
What Product needs from release evidence to unblock the Release Agent.

WATCH-OUTS

The Rules Engine platform is undecided; if it lands on Core, the template may need adjusting.
The sanctioned AI tools and PHI rule must be in place first.
Ways of working only: no production-system change.

Owner: Product + Engineering Team Lead | Buckets: Quality (tech spec) and Release (Release Agent) | Measure: time from PRD to signed spec, rework after review

Activation Roadmap: engineering track

RECOMMENDATION / PILOT / OWNER	NOW	NEXT	FUTURE
E1 Release stability Core · E+R+Q	Review 15 unplanned 2026 changes; inventory credentials/certificates with owners.	Review patches/rollbacks; expiry alerts; same-artifact promotion; new products into CAB.	Every pod tracks change failure, restore time and repeat causes.
E2 Test automation Core · Q+E	Map highest-risk regression workflows and manual effort per release.	Automate those workflows; extend Recon patterns to Eligibility AI and Pay Connect.	Automated regression becomes a release entry criterion on every pod.
E3 Access / test data Recon + Rules · D+S	Log who waits for access/data, for what and how long.	Masked production-like Recon data; read-only diagnostics including offshore.	Self-service environments and access on every pod.
E4 Delivery measures Core + Recon · E	Baseline frequency, lead time, change failure rate and restore time.	Activate Recon flow metrics; monthly delivery view includes vendor team.	Measures guide prioritization and portfolio decisions.
E5 Governed AI Reconcile AI · E+P	Automate / assist / human review; sanctioned PHI tools.	Registry + Eligibility AI; light Core pilot; December rollout.	Scale only what improves speed and quality together.
Pilot → measure → extend. Owners: P Product; E Engineering; R Release/Ops; O Operations; Q Quality; D DevOps/Infrastructure; S Security.			

Engineering Priority: Quality

STATUS TODAY

Defects reach production: at least 3 in 2026, plus 2 rollbacks, in the Core calendar.
Only Reconcile AI has an owned technical design step before build.
Delivery is not measured end to end, and the vendor team is not measured on delivery.

NOW
Rules
Core
Recon

Rules Engine PRD → Architecture Design Agent spec; Team Lead reviews/signs.
Baseline release frequency, lead time, change failure and restore time.

NEXT

Core tech spec template; Recon flow metrics live; monthly quality view including the vendor team.

FUTURE

Quality measures inform prioritization and portfolio decisions.

Agentic lens: the Architecture Design Agent drafts the spec from the PRD; people review and sign before any build starts.
Owner: Engineering leadership + Product | Measure: change failure rate, escaped defects, and lead time

Engineering Priority: Test

STATUS TODAY

Core regression is manual, with limited QA capacity.

Reconcile AI's verification agents write Jest, Playwright, and Postman tests per story.

XConnect is ~100% automated; other pods are partially automated.

Teams wait for access, test data, and read-only diagnostics; Recon waited months for production-like data.

QA uses Claude to create tests and diagnose failures; access is limited to some full-time staff.

NOW
Rules
Core
Recon

Core: map highest-risk regression and manual effort, using Release root causes. Log access/data waiters, reasons and duration.

NEXT

Automate Core high-risk workflows; extend Recon test agents to Eligibility AI and Pay Connect; provide masked data and read-only diagnostics.

FUTURE

Automated regression as a release entry criterion on every pod. Self-service environments and access.

Agentic lens: Recon agents write and trace tests; QA uses Claude to draft tests and diagnose failures, time-boxed and reviewed before every PR.
Owner: Quality leadership + DevOps/Infrastructure + Security | Measure: automated coverage of high-risk workflows, escaped defects, wait time

Engineering Priority: Release

STATUS TODAY

Core engineering reports 62 releases through September 1, 15 of them patches; in the calendar, half of 2026 release events were unplanned.

Release-night branch merges suggest production may be rebuilt rather than promoted.

Some new products are not yet in the CAB process.

Credential and certificate changes ship as patches.

NOW Core Recon

Review causes of 15 unplanned 2026 changes; inventory credential/certificate owners and expiry dates; Product defines Release Agent notes, PRD reconciliation and destinations.

NEXT

Promote validated artifacts; expiry alerts and patch/rollback reviews; onboard products to CAB (clarify config switches); run Recon Release Agent in staging.

FUTURE

On-demand releases for low-risk changes, gated by automated evidence. Release Agent pattern on every pod.

Agentic lens: the Release Agent reconciles delivered work against the PRD and drafts release notes, so release evidence is produced, not assembled.
Owner: Engineering leadership + Release/DevOps | Measure: share of unplanned changes, rollbacks, and repeat causes

Evidence behind the map

OBSERVED STRENGTHS Pockets worth scaling

Portfolio governance and commercialization gates are emerging. · Reconcile AI shows a leading agentic delivery pocket. · Engineering skills, MSPs, and a Git-based source of truth are documented.

OBSERVED GAPS Constraints to resolve

Customer commitments and late scope changes reduce predictability. · Product ownership often centers on intake, backlog, and sprint scope. · Engineering, UX, QA, Release, and Operations often join after key commitments.

MAPPED OPPORTUNITIES Future-state themes

Outcome-led prioritization and protected capacity. · Product management as business ownership. · Earlier cross-functional collaboration. · Governed, reusable agentic delivery across the lifecycle.

Recommendations summary: what should be done

RECOMMENDATION	ACTION	ACTIVATION HORIZON
Outcome-led prioritization	Set decision criteria, protect capacity, and make 3-4 sprint visibility credible before commitments are made.	Immediate
Product management as business ownership	Clarify PM accountability for evidence, outcomes, roadmap, adoption, and learning beyond backlog administration.	Immediate
Opportunity brief to implementation path	Standardize the artifact and decision path from internal signal through PRD, feature brief, epic, technical design, and implementation plan.	Immediate
Earlier cross-functional collaboration	Bring UX, Engineering, QA, Release, and Operations into feasibility, evidence, and living documentation earlier.	Near-term
Governed agentic delivery	Define reusable, human-supervised AI practices and measures from discovery through post-launch learning.	Future

Outcome-led prioritization

Make priority and commitment decisions from evidence about outcomes, feasibility, and capacity.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Set explicit decision criteria for value, urgency, feasibility, and dependency before commitments are made.

Protect capacity for high-value work, with an explicit allocation for support, patches, and escalations and show a credible 3-4 sprint view.

Require Engineering-informed effort and risk input before customer dates become commitments.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Select one live initiative and apply the criteria to the next prioritization decision.

Compare the committed scope with evidence and capacity, then record the trade-off.

Review predictability, scope changes, and rework in the activation cadence, using flow data where teams have moved off story points.

Owner: Product leadership + Engineering leadership | Dependency: roadmap, customer commitments, capacity data | Measure: commitment predictability, late scope change rate, and share of capacity spent on unplanned work

Product management as business ownership

Shift Product accountability toward customer evidence, outcomes, roadmap, adoption, and learning.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Define what Product owns from opportunity through post-launch learning, separate from backlog administration.

Clarify decision rights across Product Manager, Product Owner, Engineering Lead, Sales, and Operations.

Use the opportunity brief and PRD to carry business context and decision logic into delivery.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Map current decision rights and identify one gap that slows the live initiative.

Assign a PM owner for the initiative's outcome and learning loop.

Review adoption, customer evidence, and business results in the same cadence as delivery progress.

Owner: Product leadership | Dependency: role clarity, customer and usage data, outcome measures | Measure: decisions supported by evidence and post-launch learning captured

Opportunity brief to implementation path

Make the decision path from an internal signal to an implementation plan visible and repeatable.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Standardize the minimum content for an opportunity brief: problem, evidence, outcome, decision, and why now.

Carry the decision logic through product brief or PRD, feature brief, epic, technical design and implementation plan.

Make ownership, acceptance, design context, dependencies, and release evidence explicit before delivery scope is committed.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Select one internal signal from a live initiative and complete the opportunity brief.

Review the brief with Product, Engineering, UX, and the initiative sponsor before creating the PRD.

Trace the same decision through the feature brief, epic, technical design and implementation plan, then record handoff gaps and rework.

Owner: Product + Engineering | Dependency: shared templates, architectural spec template, design context, initiative sponsor | Measure: handoff quality, rework, and decision clarity before commitment

Earlier cross-functional collaboration

Bring the right people and evidence into feasibility work before commitments harden.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Define the minimum cross-functional team and artifact set required before a commitment is ready.

Include Product, UX, Engineering, QA, Release, and Operations in early feasibility and evidence work.

Maintain living documentation in a source of truth that supports handoffs and reuse.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Choose one initiative and run a pre-commitment working session.

Capture the open feasibility, design, release, and operational questions in one shared record.

Measure wait time, rework, and late discovery of issues before and after the test.

Owner: Product + Engineering | Dependency: stakeholder access, cadence, Figma and design context | Measure: rework, wait time, and issues found before commitment

Ship with proof feedback loop

Move from release coordination to evidence that a product works in a realistic client environment.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Define the smallest release evidence path for each selected initiative, including workflow, data, owner, and decision threshold.

Create realistic partner-system or client-facing validation where current test data and environments are not representative.

Carry post-launch results, issues, and adoption signals back into the next roadmap and prioritization decision.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Use the Reconcile AI release path as the first test and identify the highest-risk client workflow.

Complete an evidence review before release with Product, Engineering, Release, Operations, and the initiative owner.

Compare issues found before versus after release, then update the checklist and roadmap based on what the evidence shows.

Owner: Product + Release + Operations | Dependency: realistic test data, partner environments, enablement | Measure: validation coverage, post-release defects, and time to feedback

Governed agentic delivery throughout the lifecycle

Extend the Reconcile AI pocket into reusable, human-supervised practices across the PDLC.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Classify lifecycle tasks that are safe to automate, require assistance, or require mandatory human review, and name the sanctioned tools for PHI-bearing work.

Create reusable skills, prompts, documentation, and versioning that teams can discover and reuse.

Track speed and quality together through cycle time, defects, rework, cost, and review evidence.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Now (Reconcile AI): classify pipeline steps as automate, assist, or human review, and name the sanctioned tools for PHI-bearing work.

Next: extend to Eligibility AI with a shared agent registry, and pilot a light, human-gated pattern on Core, ahead of the December rollout.

Future: scale only the patterns that improve speed and quality together.

Owner: Engineering + Product | Dependency: model access, agent registry, developer hardware, design context, cost, security, governance | Measure: cycle time, defects, rework, cost, and reuse

Activation Roadmap

TIMING	RECOMMENDATION	FIRST ACTION	PROPOSED OWNER	DEPENDENCY	INITIAL MEASURE
Immediate	Prioritize outcomes	Apply criteria to the next live priority decision.	Product + Eng	Decision criteria	Predictability
Immediate	PM business ownership	Name PM outcome owner; map decision rights.	Product	Role clarity	Outcome learning
Immediate	Definition path	Run signal → opportunity → PRD → feature/epic → design → plan.	Product + Eng	Shared artifacts	Handoff quality
Near-term	Earlier collaboration	Hold a minimum-team feasibility review before commitment.	Product + Eng	Cadence and access	Rework and wait time
Near-term	Ship with proof	Define next test's release evidence and post-launch learning.	Product + Release	Measures	Validation coverage
Future	Governed agentic delivery	Test human-supervised AI outside the current pocket.	Eng + Product	Guardrails and skills	Cycle time, defects, cost

Use the roadmap after each quick-win test to update timing, owners, dependencies, measures, and the Phase 2 enablement need.

Implementation Templates

The briefs and plans that are included as part of the R&D Operating Model project, when to use them, and the different ways of contributing.

Executive Summary

Deliverables

Recommended Next Phase

Six artifacts turn definition into decisions

01 Opportunity Brief

Identify · Steps 01–02. Evidence-backed problem before choosing a solution. Owner: PM. Senior leader decides if worth defining. Pilot: Rules Engine, rebuilt from PGB deck.

02 Product Brief

Define · Step 03 (PRD). Direction, outcome, experience, scope and measures. Owner: PM. Senior leader approves direction/measures. Pilot: Rules Engine vs existing PRD.

03 Feature Brief

Define → Build · Step 04. Stories, rules, acceptance, tracking. Owner: PM + Eng lead. Product / Eng / QA or Design approve build readiness. Pilot: Rules Engine first epic.

04 Technical Implementation Plan

Build · Steps 05–06. Architecture, data, environments, rollback, reviewed AI. Owner: Eng lead. Eng + reviewers approve execution. Pilot: Rules Engine agent-drafted tech spec.

05 Testing, QA, and UAT Plan

Define → Release · Parallel. Test coverage, data, uncertainty and acceptance. Owner: QA / Eng test lead; Product owns UAT. Decision: release readiness. Pilot: Recon, before November MVP.

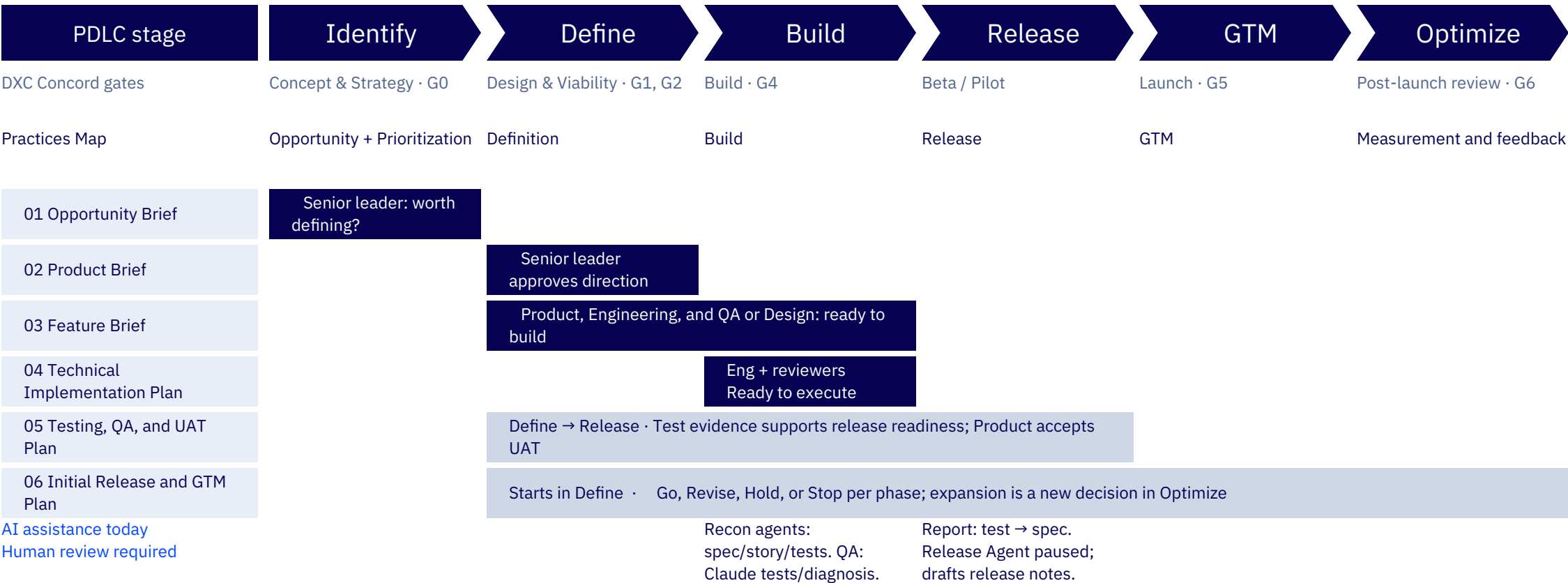
06 Initial Release and GTM Plan

Define → Optimize · Parallel. First release, audience, functional readiness, expansion. Owner: PM + functional leads. Named decision-maker: Go / Revise / Hold / Stop. Pilot: Recon first release.

Linked by readable IDs: OPPORTUNITY → PRODUCT → FEATURE → ACCEPTANCE → TEST → METRIC · Proposed working templates and pilots, to validate with DXC.

Artifacts link stages to review decisions

Testing and release plans start in Define. Each bar names a review decision. Navy bars form the sequential chain; gray bars run in parallel.



Reviews end in Approve, Revise, Hold or Stop. Link Jira, design and tests. Unknowns retain an owner/date. Product + Engineering agree before customer, scope or date commitments.

Artifact ownership matrix

L · Lead C · Contribute A · Approve

ROLE / STAKEHOLDER	OPPORTUNITY	PRODUCT	FEATURE	TECHNICAL PLAN	QA / UAT	RELEASE / GTM
Product Manager / Product Lead	L	L	C	C	C	L
Business / Initiative Sponsor	A	A	C	C	C	A
Product Owner / Delivery Lead	C	C	L	C	C	C
UX / Design	C	C	C	C	C	C
Engineering Lead / Architect	C	C	C	L	C	C
QA / UAT	C	C	C	C	L	C
Release / Operations	C	C	C	C	C	A
Sales / Customer Success	C	C	C	C	C	C
Leadership	C	C	C	C	C	C

Lead coordinates the artifact; contributors shape it; approvers decide readiness. Use these templates as decision points in the work, not documents completed after the fact.

Recommended Next Phase

Executive Summary

Deliverables

Recommended Next Phase

Product strategy spike

Clear product strategy and an executable six-month roadmap

Build the evidence base

Review customer needs, product performance, and business priorities.

Align on product strategy

Prepare and facilitate a focused strategy workshop with product leaders.

Define priorities and success measures

Set product-area direction, measurable outcomes, and roadmap trade-offs.

Make the roadmap actionable

Complete product briefs, ownership, and roadmap for the next six months.

Product direction, priorities, and a practical path to execution

4-week spike

Executive Product Strategist · Part time · Sameer Karim

Senior Product Strategist · Full time · Mzati Kapalamula

Product direction and a six-month roadmap.

Scale Reconcile AI engineering across Core

Reusable practices tested on a Core rules-engine pilot

Assess and refine

Weeks 1–3: refine Recon’s AI library and Core specification workflows.

Run a hands-on workshop

Week 4: apply refined AI practices to real Core epics with the team.

Coach adoption

Weeks 5–6: test library reuse with Core teams and plan rollout.

Decide the next gate

Review pilot specifications and access before any build extension.

6-week activation

Executive Engineering Leader · Part time · leader to confirm

Senior Architect · Full time · Gerardo Arroyo

A refined, process-oriented skill library
A process map for core SDLC process enhancements

Integration of SDLC enhancements with ongoing metrics and measurement systems, aligned with product-side metrics
Delivery of a three-day training workshop for select members of the Dental Exchange engineering team

Hands-on engineering coaching

Six weeks to pilot and scale reusable AI engineering practices.

Strengthen Core testing and release controls

More reliable release gates and critical-path test coverage

Prioritize critical paths

Weeks 1–2: confirm journeys, coverage gaps and release gates with Product.

Expand automated testing

Weeks 3–4: strengthen Playwright coverage and reusable AI test workflows.

Validate release controls

Weeks 5–6: exercise priority tests and release checks in staging.

Coach and transfer ownership

Assign test owners and scope remaining pipeline and environment improvements.

6-week activation

TEAM

Executive Engineering Leader · part time
QE Architect · full time
QE Senior Engineer · full time

DELIVERABLES

Testing assessment and focus areas
Environment / release control recommendations
One sprint of added end-to-end testing capacity
Agentic skills for faster test creation
Intellio Evolve evidence database and critical-user-journey inventory

Six weeks to improve critical-path coverage and release confidence.

Parallel workstreams, combined investment

01 Product strategy spike

4 weeks

Sameer Karim · Executive Product Strategy
(part time)

Mzati Kapalamula · Senior Product Strategist
(full time)

02 Reconcile AI engineering across Core

6 weeks

Ri Scott · Executive Engineering Leader (part
time)

Gerardo Arroyo · Senior Architect · full time

03 Testing & release controls

6 weeks

Ri Scott · Executive Engineering Leader (part
time)

Quality Engineering Architect · full time

Quality Engineering Senior Engineer · full
time

ALL THREE WORKSTREAMS: Total fees \$370,000 – Phase 1 credit \$25,000 = Total investment \$345,000

Executive summary

PRODUCT TRACK		ENGINEERING TRACK
What we saw	[To be completed by the product team]	Two platforms at very different maturity: Reconcile AI leads on technical design, AI-assisted build, and test automation, while Core relies on manual regression. Half of 2026 Core production changes were unplanned, and delivery is not measured end to end.
What we recommend now	[To be completed by the product team]	Five engineering recommendations, each starting with one pilot: a root-cause review of unplanned changes (E1), a map of Core's highest-risk regression (E2), wait times for access and test data (E3), a delivery baseline (E4), and sanctioned tools for agentic work (E5).
How it rolls out	[To be completed by the product team]	One pilot pod per recommendation: Core for release stability and quality, Reconcile AI and the Rules Engine for environments and data, Reconcile AI for agentic delivery. What works extends to Eligibility AI, Pay Connect, and the other pods, with a light, human-gated version for Core.
What we need from leadership	[To be completed by the product team]	An owner for each of E1–E5, agreement on the pilot pods, the sanctioned AI tools and PHI rule before the December AIDLC rollout, and access to release and Jira data to build the baseline.
Both tracks use the same horizons: Now (readout and first 30 days), Next (1–3 months), and Future (3–6+ months).		

Practices Map · working ratings

Practice area	Identify	Prioritization	Definition	Build	Release	GTM
Customer evidence	Emerging	Developing	-	-	-	-
Roadmap and prioritization	Developing	Developing	-	-	-	-
Ownership and decisions	-	Developing	Developing	-	-	-
Product definition and design	-	-	Developing	Developing	-	-
Product and Engineering delivery	-	-	-	Variable / pocket	-	-
Release validation	-	-	-	-	Emerging	-
Commercialization and enablement	-	-	-	-	Developing	Developing
Measurement and feedback	-	-	-	-	-	Developing
AI-enabled delivery	Emerging	-	Developing	Leading pocket	Developing	-

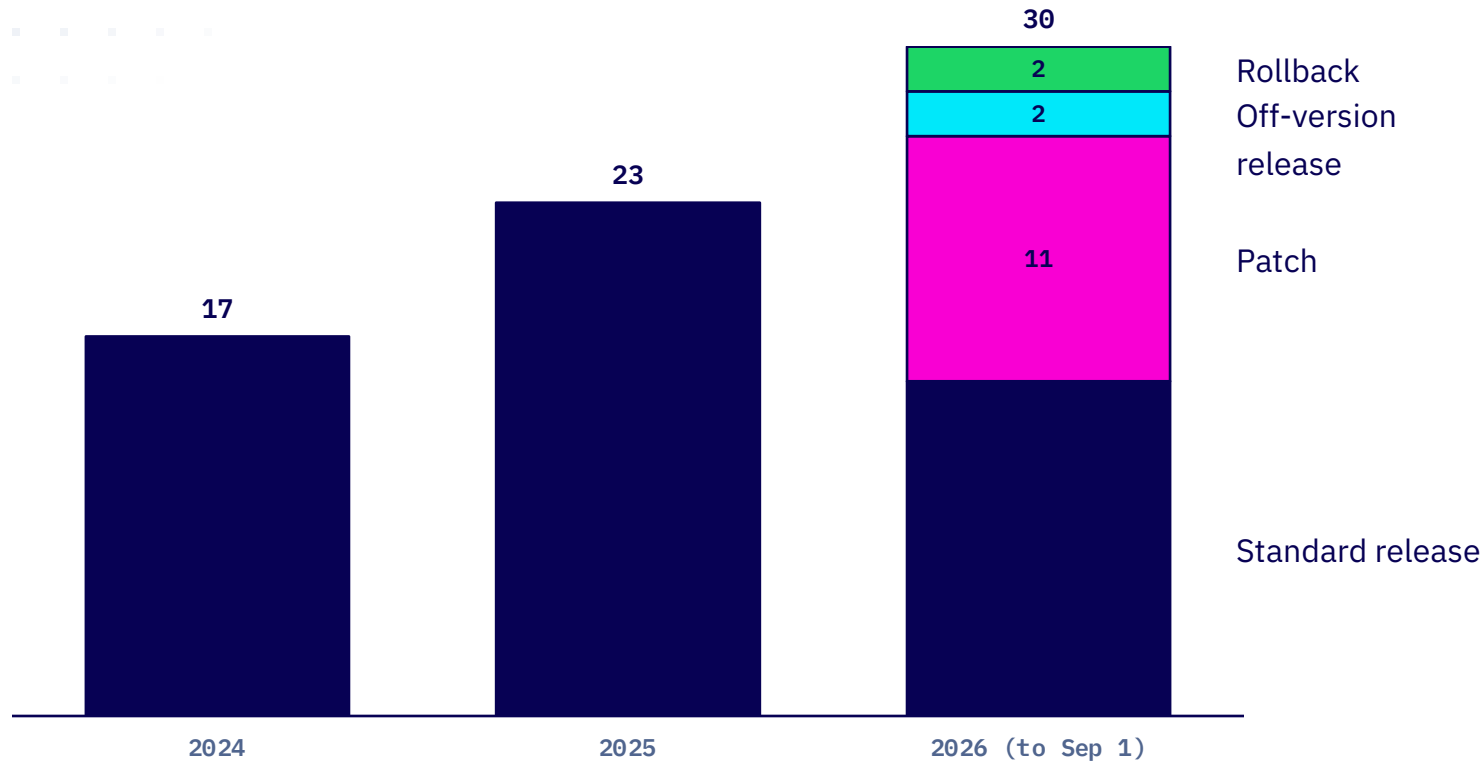
Ratings are working hypotheses based on limited conversations and observations with DXC team.

Engineering practices by platform

PRACTICE	CORE JAVA	RECONCILE AI	OTHER PODS	EVIDENCE	ACTION
Technical design	Emerging	Leading pocket	To validate	No design owner before build; Core knowledge concentrated. Recon spec: Team Lead signs.	Rec 03
AI-assisted build	Developing	Leading pocket	Variable	Core Copilot since Jan 2026, human gates; Recon epic agents; others mainly unit tests.	E5
Test automation	Emerging	Leading pocket	Variable	Core manual, limited QA. Recon: Jest / Playwright / Postman. XConnect ~100%; others partial.	E2
Release promotion	Developing	Developing	To validate	Release-night merges suggest rebuild vs promotion (confirm); some products outside CAB.	E1
Access / test data	Emerging	Emerging	Emerging	Survey: access/data delays, no read-only DB diagnostics. Recon data wait: months.	E3
Operability / run	Developing	To validate	To validate	Half 2026 Core changes outside cadence: defects, rollbacks, credential/certificate fixes.	E1
Delivery measures	Emerging	Emerging	Emerging	Core ~65 points/sprint. Recon flow measures proposed, not live. No DORA measures.	E4
Knowledge sharing	Emerging	Emerging	Emerging	Senior-person dependency; thin onboarding. New onshore leads being added.	Rec 04

Working hypotheses to validate with Engineering. Sources: working sessions; engineering survey n=44; 2024–2026 release calendar.

Release health baseline, 2024–2026

**50%**

15 of 30 off cadence: 11 patches, 2 off-version, 2 rollbacks.

5 of 11

Patches: credentials/certificates; two expired Salesforce passwords blocked client workflows.

2

DEA (Jan), DCQ (Aug); also a held DCQ item after failed January checkout.

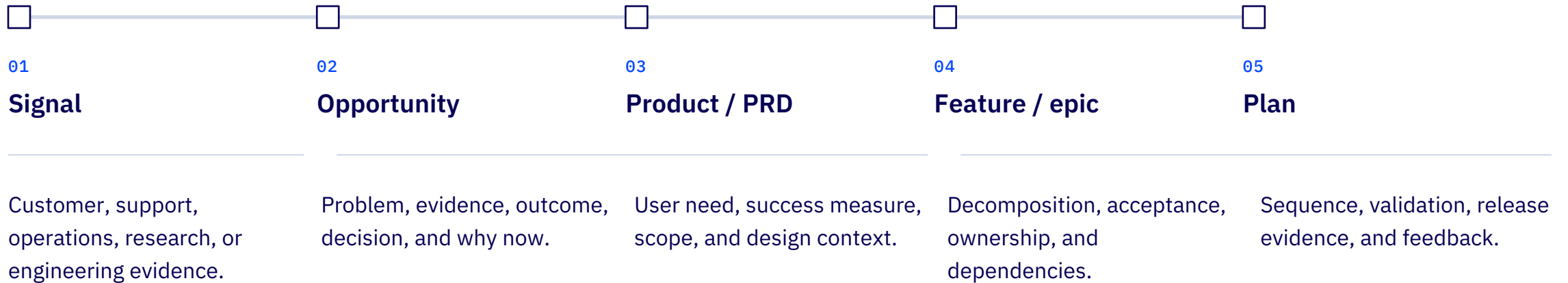
Half of 2026 changes were unplanned: defects, rollbacks, and credential or certificate fixes. Each merits a root-cause review (E1).
Source: DXC Production Release Calendar, Jan 2024 – Sep 2026; Core applications only; 2024–25 did not label patches.

Capture each bounded activation

ACTIVATION RECORD	WORKING INPUT TO COMPLETE
Selected initiative and baseline	Add initiative, participants, cadence, and artifact set.
Methodology or process change	Name the change in the way work flows, including opportunity brief, product brief / PRD, feature brief, epic, technical design or implementation plan.
Practice, role, decision, meeting, artifact, or measure	Name what changed, who changed it, and what artifact or decision point made the change visible.
Observed result or early signal	Add evidence, open questions, risks, and what changed in the work.
Recommended activation playbook	Describe the repeatable cadence, owner, evidence, guardrail, and decision needed to continue.
Bounded activation stays within ways of working. It does not include production-system change, software development, or broad implementation. The first working test to capture: carry one internal signal through opportunity brief, PRD, feature brief, epic, technical design, and implementation plan.	

From signal to implementation plan

A working definition path to test in one selected live initiative.



Test intent: make decision logic, feasibility, design context, and evidence visible before the team commits to delivery scope.

Recommendations summary: what should be done

TRACK	RECOMMENDATION	WHAT SHOULD BE DONE	STARTS
Product	01 Prioritize outcomes	Criteria + protected capacity + credible 3–4 sprint view.	Now
	02 PM business ownership	PM owns evidence, outcomes, adoption and learning.	Now
	03 Definition path	Signal → PRD → epic → technical design → plan.	Now
	04 Earlier collaboration	UX, Eng, QA, Release and Ops join early feasibility.	Next
	05 Ship with proof	Minimum release proof feeds post-launch roadmap learning.	Next
Eng	E1 Release stability	Root causes + credential/certificate lifecycle.	Now · C
	E2 Test automation	Automate high-risk regression; reuse Recon patterns.	Now · C
	E3 Access / test data	Remove access waits; provide realistic masked data.	Now · R/RE
	E4 Delivery measures	Release/flow measures across platforms, incl. vendors.	Now · C/R
	E5 Governed AI	Supervised AI + sanctioned tools before December rollout.	Now · R

Eng Engineering; C Core; R Reconcile AI; RE Rules Engine. Product recommendations precede Engineering; both tracks roll up in the two roadmaps.

Release stability and production quality

Learn from what reaches production and stop repeat causes, starting with Core.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Review the root cause of every unplanned production change: patches, rollbacks, and off-version releases.

Manage credentials and certificates as a lifecycle, with expiry dates, owners, and alerts.

Make releases repeatable: promote the same validated artifact, onboard new products to CAB, and clarify how the release rule applies to code behind a configuration switch.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Now (Core): classify the 15 unplanned 2026 changes by cause and build the credential and certificate inventory.

Next: a standard review after every patch or rollback, expiry alerts, and same-artifact promotion.

Future: change failure rate, time to restore, and repeat causes tracked on every pod.

Owner: Engineering leadership + Release/DevOps + Quality | Dependency: release calendar, Jira, CAB records | Measure: share of unplanned changes, change failure rate, and repeat causes

Quality and test automation

Move quality earlier so fewer defects reach production, starting where regression is manual.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Target automation by risk, starting with the workflows behind the highest-impact defects and rollbacks.

Reuse the test-generation patterns already working in Reconcile AI where the stack allows.

Make automated regression evidence part of the release decision.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Now (Core): map the highest-risk regression workflows and the manual effort each release consumes, using E1's root-cause categories.

Next: automate those workflows in Core and extend Recon's test patterns to Eligibility AI and Pay Connect.

Future: automated regression becomes a release entry criterion on every pod.

Owner: Quality leadership + Engineering leads | Dependency: E1 root-cause data, QA capacity, test environments | Measure: automated coverage of high-risk workflows, escaped defects, and regression effort per release

Environments, access, and test data

Remove the waits for access and realistic data that slow both build and validation.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Make access and test-data wait times visible, by team and by type of request.

Provide masked, production-like test data on a refresh cadence, within HIPAA and PHI rules.

Give engineers, including offshore teams, approved read-only access for diagnostics.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Now (Reconcile AI and Rules Engine): log who waits for access and test data, for what, and for how long.

Next: masked, production-like data for Recon and a read-only diagnostic access path.

Future: self-service environments and access provisioning on every pod.

Owner: DevOps/Infrastructure + Security | Dependency: data masking approach, security review, environment capacity | Measure: wait time for access and test data

Delivery measurement

See how work moves from commit to production, across internal and vendor teams.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE



Agree a small set of release and flow measures that every platform reports the same way.

Build them from data that already exists: the release calendar and Jira.

Include the offshore vendor team in the same view, measured on delivery rather than headcount.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT



Now (Core and Reconcile AI): baseline release frequency, lead time, change failure rate, and time to restore.

Next: turn on Recon's proposed flow metrics and publish one monthly delivery view.

Future: the measures inform prioritization and portfolio decisions.

Owner: Engineering leadership | Dependency: Jira hygiene, release calendar, data access | Measure: teams with live measures, and the trend in lead time and change failure rate

Activation Roadmap: product track

TIMING	RECOMMENDATION	FIRST ACTION	PROPOSED OWNER	DEPENDENCY	INITIAL MEASURE
Now	Prioritize outcomes	Apply criteria to the next live priority decision.	Product + Eng	Decision criteria	Predictability
Now	PM business ownership	Name PM outcome owner; map decision rights.	Product	Role clarity	Outcome learning
Now	Definition path	Run signal → opportunity → PRD → feature/epic → design → plan.	Product + Eng	Shared artifacts	Handoff quality
Next	Earlier collaboration	Hold a minimum-team feasibility review before commitment.	Product + Eng	Cadence and access	Rework and wait time
Next	Ship with proof	Define next test's release evidence and post-launch learning.	Product + Release	Measures	Validation coverage

Use the roadmap after each quick-win test to update timing, owners, dependencies, measures, and the Phase 2 enablement need.

Artifact ownership matrix

L · Lead C · Contribute I · Inform A · Approve

ROLE / STAKEHOLDER	OPPORTUNITY	PRODUCT	FEATURE	TECHNICAL PLAN	QA / UAT	RELEASE / GTM
Product Manager / Product Lead	L	L	C	I	C	L
Business / Initiative Sponsor	A	A	I	I	I	A
Product Owner / Delivery Lead	C	C	L	C	C	C
UX / Design	C	C	C	I	I	C
Engineering Lead / Architect	C	C	C	L	C	C
QA / UAT	I	I	C	C	L	C
Release / Operations	I	I	C	C	C	A
Sales / Customer Success	I	C	I	I	I	C
Leadership	I	I	I	I	I	I

A marks the stage-gate approver(s). Multiple approvals are intentional where Product, Engineering, QA, or Release share a readiness decision. The lead owns the handoff to the next artifact.

Why this work matters

BUSINESS NEED

DentalXChange is growing and maturing its SaaS business model. Leadership wants to identify meaningful opportunities quickly, then activate changes through live work.

The value is a faster, more consistent delivery system that can keep pace with growth.

Up to two

live initiatives

Up to three

bounded quick wins

Three weeks

from launch to executive readout

No

production-system change

Activation Roadmap: engineering priorities

RECOMMENDATION / PILOT / OWNER	NOW	NEXT	FUTURE
Release Core + Recon · E+R	Review unplanned changes; credential inventory; define Release Agent outputs.	Same artifact; expiry alerts; patch/rollback reviews; Recon Release Agent live.	On-demand low-risk release; Release Agent pattern on every pod.
Test Core + Recon + Rules Q+D+S	Map Core high-risk regression; log access/data waits.	Automate high-risk paths; agents in Eligibility AI / Pay Connect; masked data.	Regression as release entry criterion; self-service environments.
Quality Rules + Core + Recon E+P	Rules PRD → agent tech spec; baseline four delivery measures.	Core tech spec template; Recon flow metrics; monthly quality view.	Quality measures guide prioritization and portfolio decisions.
AI guardrail All pods · E+P+S	Approve PHI rule/tools; staff + contractor access before December rollout.	Govern December AIDLC rollout; shared agent registry.	Scale what improves speed and quality together.
Rollout sequence	Pilot Core, Reconcile AI and Rules Engine.	Extend to Eligibility AI and Pay Connect.	Other pods; Core uses a light, human-gated AI version.

Pilot → measure → extend. Owners: P Product; E Engineering; R Release/Ops; O Operations; Q Quality; D DevOps/Infrastructure; S Security.

Product strategy spike

Clear product direction and an executable six-month roadmap

Build the evidence base

Review customer needs, product performance, and business priorities.

Align on product strategy

Prepare and facilitate a focused strategy workshop with product leaders.

Define priorities and success measures

Set product-area direction, measurable outcomes, and roadmap trade-offs.

Make the roadmap actionable

Complete product briefs, ownership, and handoffs for the next six months.

4-week spike

Executive Product Strategy · Part time · Sameer Karim

Senior Product Strategist · Full time · Mzati Kapalamula

INVESTMENT · ALL 3 WORKSTREAMS

Total fees \$370,000

Credit memo (\$25,000)

Total investment \$345,000

Product direction, priorities, and a practical path to execution